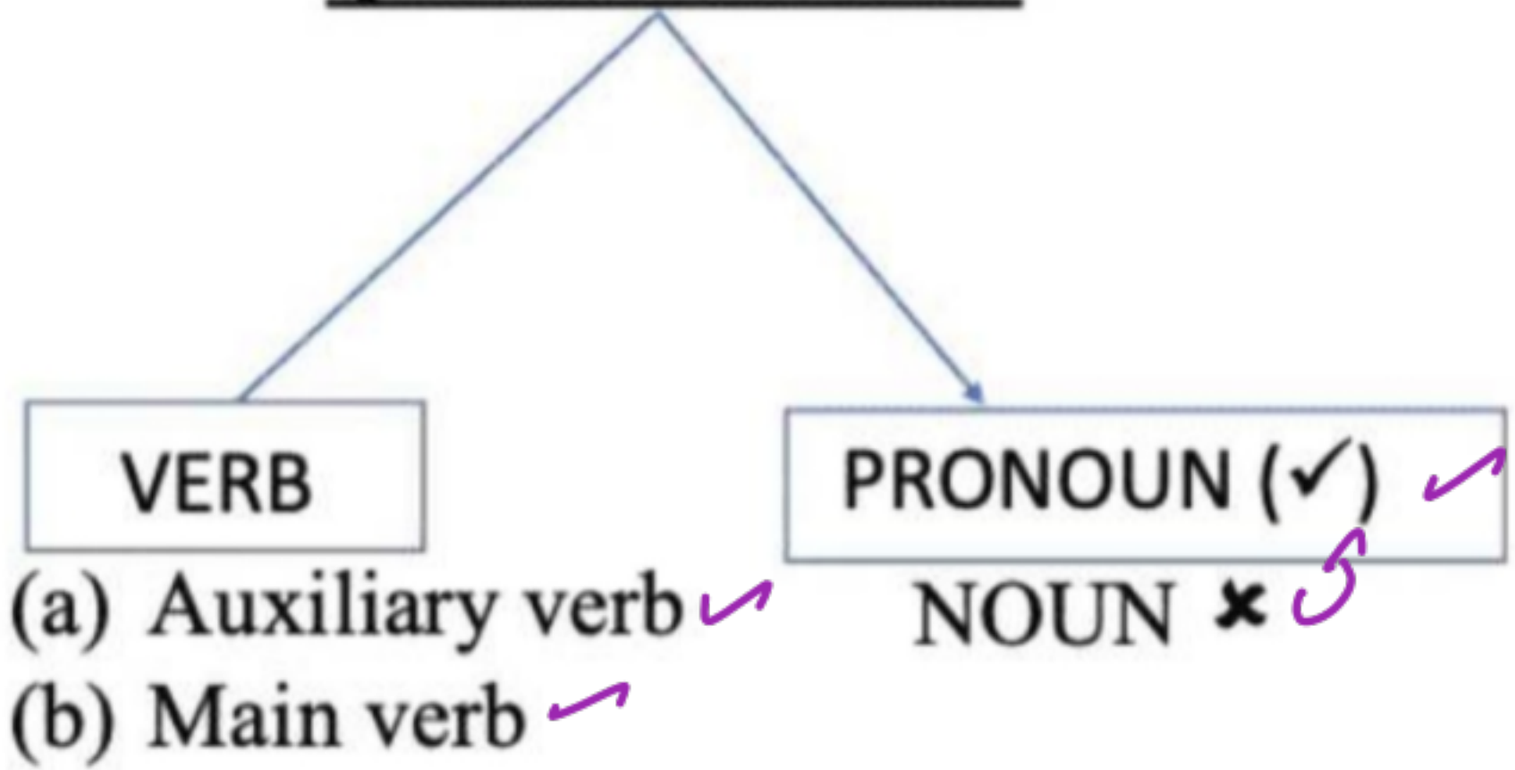
They are used for **confirmation**/**surety**/**certainty**.

QUESTION TAG



BASIC RULE→

(i) If sentence is **positive**, tag is **negative**

(ii) If sentence is **negative**, tag is **positive**

Ex:

(a) The students were working on the project, **weren't they?**

(b) They did not come on time, **did they?**

NOTE:

If there is no auxiliary verb, the tag is made by using **DO/DOES/DID**

Ex:

(a) Children like to eat sweets, **don't they?**

(b) The earth revolves around the sun, **doesn't it?**

(c) The student did the work, **didn't he?**

(d) Barking dogs seldom bite, **do they?**

Some contracted forms:-

Do + not = don't

Does + not = doesn't

Did + not = didn't

Am I not .... = Aren't I ... ?

Is + not = isn't

Are + not = aren't

Have + not = haven't

Has + not = hasn't

Had + not = hadn't

Was + not = wasn't

Were + not = weren't

Shall + not = shan't

Will + not = won't

Can + not = can't

May + not = mayn't

Might + not = mightn't

Could + not = couldn't

Would + not = wouldn't

Should + not = shouldn't

Ought + not = oughtn't

Must + not = mustn't

Need + not = needn't

Dare + not = daren't

Used + not = usedn't

NOTE:

There are certain words which are negative.

Ex: hardly, scarcely, barely, rarely, neither, seldom, little, few, none, nothing, nobody

(a) He takes little effort, **does he?**

(b) A little knowledge is a dangerous thing, **isn't it?**

(c) The little milk left in the bottle turned sour, **didn't it?**

(d) It rarely rains here, **does it?**

(e) Few people will come, **will they?**

(f) A few students got the award, **didn't they?**

Q.Tag

Is/am/are/was/were
- M.V
- A.V

am I/ are I/ was I/ were I

.. ..

Do/does/did
- M.V
- A.V

do/does/did

.. ..

Have/has/had

do does did

- M.V — do/does/did
- A.V — have I/ has I/ had

He is busy, isn't he?

He is writing, isn't he?

I am busy, aren't I?

I am not busy, am I?

He hardly works, does he?

It rarely rains, does it?

He scarcely comes on time, does he?

They often help me, don't they?

Question tags with **HAVE/HAS/HAD**

1) The women has a beautiful car, **doesn't she?**
2) You have to phone a taxi, **don't you?**
3) She had her bedroom redone, **didn't she?**
4) The girl has done the work, **hasn't she?**
5) You haven't got any money, **have you?**
6) The man had sold the house, **hadn't he?**
7) Anu is having her hair cut, **isn't she?**
8) She never had her name revealed, **did she?**

There are certain nouns which are singular as well as plural.

Ex:

Team, jury, audience, panel, board, committee, council, mob, government, parliament.

Ex

1) The team won the match, **didn't it?**
2) The team tried the uniforms, **didn't they?**
3) The mob killed the magistrate, **didn't it?**
4) The jury gave a unanimous opinion, **didn't it?**
5) The jury gave a divided opinion, **didn't they?**

Singular – doesn't / don't
Plural – They

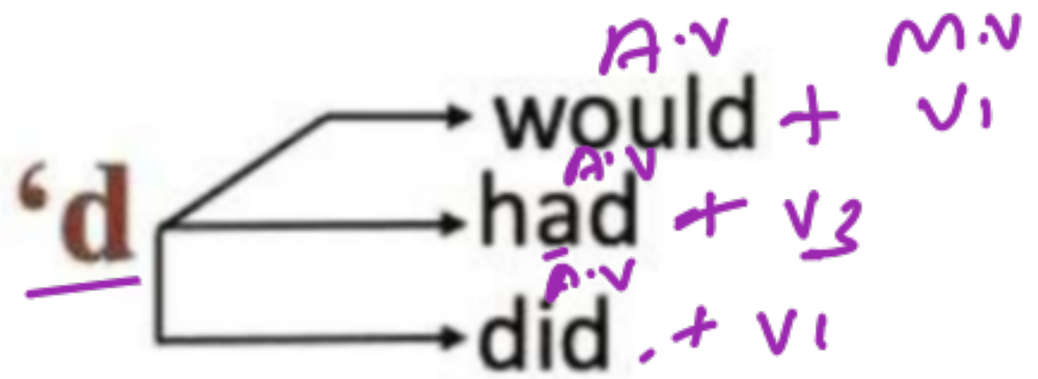


Ex:

(i) He's got a beautiful house, **hasn't he?**

(ii) It's raining heavily today, **isn't it?**

(iii) He's busy in his work yesterday, **wasn't he?**



Ex:

1) I'd not attend the party yesterday, **did I?**
2) I'd like to have tea rather than coffee, **wouldn't I?**
3) He'd completed the work on time, **had he?**

verb

LET'S (Let + us) → It takes the tag **shall we**?

Ex:

1) Let's help her to complete the work, **shall we**?
2) Let's not disturb them, **shall we**?
3) Let's play together, **shall we**?

(1) If the sentence starts with **THIS/THAT**, the pronoun used in the tag is "**IT**"

(2) If the sentence starts with **THESE/THOSE** the pronoun used in the tag is "**THEY**"

(3) If the sentence starts with **THERE**, the pronoun used is "**THERE**"

Ex:

(i) These are good examples, **aren't they**?

(ii) These books are not mine, **are they**?

(iii) There is beauty in it, **isn't there**?

(iv) This is mine, **isn't it**?

(v) That was a good book, **wasn't it**?

Note:

(i) I think, he is right, **isn't he**?

(ii) As far as I know, they are the best, **aren't they**?

(iii) I hope, he does the work on time, **doesn't he**?

(iv) I know, India will win the match, **won't it**?

Note:-

One (one in number) - one of / one boy - he/she
One (everybody) - one - one

Ex:

1) One should do one's duties, **shouldn't one?**
2) One must respect one's elders, **mustn't one?**
3) One of the students was absent, **wasn't he?**
4) One girl did the work, **didn't she?**

Need. – Main verb

Need not –. Modal verb

Used --. Main verb

Used to. --. Modal verb

Dare --. Main verb

Dare not ✔ --. Modal verb

Note:

(i) He dare not go there, **dare he**?

(ii) He dares to go there, **doesn't he**?

(iii) He needs a book, **doesn't he**?

(iv) I need not ask him, **need I?**

(v) She dared to abuse him, **didn't she**?

(vi) You used to smoke, **didn't you**?

(vii) She used not to go there, **did she**?

a) Everybody/Everyone/Somebody/Someone/Nobody/Anybody→ The pronoun used in the tag is **PLURAL**.

b) Everything/Something/Nothing/Anything→ The pronoun used in the tag is **SINGULAR**.

Ex:

1) Somebody stole the pen, **didn't they**?
2) Nobody was present, **were they**?
3) Everything is clear to you, **isn't it**?
4) Something is to be done, **isn't it**?
5) Nothing was available, **was it**?

1) All of you can be beaten, **can't you?**
2) All of the them had gone there, **hadn't they?**
3) All of us can do this, **can't we?**
4) Most of us have read the book, **haven't we?**
5) Neither of you has done this, **have you?**
6) Either of you is guilty, **aren't you?**
7) Some of us must do that, **mustn't we?**

Any of

None of

In **imperative sentences** (order, request, advice, suggestion), the tag is used is **WILL YOU/WON'T YOU / WOULD YOU**

Note:

1) Negative request/command→ **WILL YOU?**
2) Positive request/command→ **WILL YOU?/WON'T YOU?**
3) Request→ **WOULD YOU?**

Ex:

1) Open the window, **will you/won't you?**
2) Don't open the window, **will you?**
3) Have some more tea, **would you?**

Imperative sentences (irritation) the tag used is can you?/can't you?

Get out of the place, can't you?/can you?